

MASTERS OF EVIL

A villainous alliance against the Avengers



Believing that there's strength in numbers, the original Baron Zemo forms a sinister super-team equal in power to the mighty Avengers.

The Masters of Evil are perennial foes of the AVENGERS, assembling multiple times over the years, often with no link between

the various groupings other than their name. The first Masters of Evil came about through the efforts of Nazi mastermind BARON ZEMO.

DECADES OF VILLAINY

Zemo schemed to defeat his wartime nemesis CAPTAIN AMERICA by enlisting the most notorious enemies of Captain America's comrades in the Avengers. He gathered the Melter to fight IRON MAN, the RADIOACTIVE MAN to fight THOR, and the BLACK KNIGHT to battle both the WASP and GIANT MAN (Henry Pym). Later, Zemo welcomed the ENCHANTRESS and the EXECUTIONER into the Masters of Evil. The team disbanded after Zemo's death.

A second Masters of Evil took its place, founded by the robot ULTRON, in his cover identity as the Crimson Cowl. The team obtained blueprints of Avengers' Mansion from butler Edwin JARVIS and struck at the Avengers in their own home. The new Black Knight, DANE WHITMAN, turned on his teammates in the Masters of Evil and helped the Avengers scatter the villains.



CHARACTER KEY

- 1 Flying Tiger
- 2 Cyclone
- 3 Klaw
- 4 Man-Killer
- 5 Tiger Shark

The criminal mastermind EGGHEAD organized a third Masters of Evil, hoping to take vengeance on Henry Pym but met defeat (and death) soon after. Helmut Zemo, son of the original Baron Zemo, brought together the fourth incarnation of the Masters.

THE DARKEST HOUR

Baron Zemo II gathered more than a dozen criminals to crush the Avengers through force of numbers. Their most infamous achievement was the siege of Avengers' Mansion.

DOCTOR OCTOPUS assembled a fifth Masters of Evil and fought the GUARDIANS OF THE GALAXY. Baron Zemo II returned to organize a sixth team, the THUNDERBOLTS, who masqueraded as heroes. Before long, most of the Thunderbolts had become heroes for real.

Justine HAMMER, the new Crimson Cowl, assembled a seventh version of the team that included a staggering 25 members. These Masters of Evil failed in an attempt to blackmail the United Nations for one trillion dollars. **DW**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Avengers Vol. 1 #6** Baron Zemo assembles the first Masters of Evil, featuring a villainous counterpart for each member of the Avengers.
- **Avengers Vol. 1 #270-277** The Masters of Evil raid their enemies' headquarters in the classic storyline "The Siege of Avengers Mansion."
- **Thunderbolts #24-25** The most recent grouping of the Masters of Evil unites 25 Super Villains, providing a formidable foe for the Thunderbolts.
- **Guardians of the Galaxy #28-29** Doctor Octopus' Masters of Evil team clash with the Guardians of the Galaxy.

FACTFILE

ORIGINAL MEMBERS AND POWERS

- BARON ZEMO** Extended longevity, brilliant criminal mind.
- MELTER** Could melt any metal with a molecular beam.
- RADIOACTIVE MAN** Can release blasts of lethal radioactive energy.
- BLACK KNIGHT** (Nathan Garrett) Skilled combatant; carried power lance.
- EXECUTIONER** Enhanced strength, carried enchanted axe.
- ENCHANTRESS** Sorceress

FIRST APPEARANCE

Avengers Vol. 1 #6
(July 1964)

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CHARACTER KEY

- 1 Black Knight
- 2 Melter
- 3 Radioactive Man